

Advanced Right-Hand Rolls

Béla Fleck uses the following right-hand roll in several of his tunes.

M T I M I T
I T I T

Béla plays this roll with lots of thumb and index finger crossing-over. The two following right-hand rolls are complements to the one Béla uses.

I M I M
T T I I

M I T M I T
I T I T

Let's call these two new rolls the 'Reverse Béla Fleck Roll' and the 'Inverse Béla Fleck Roll', respectively, because they are essentially variations of the roll that Béla uses.

If we look for a pattern that repeats every nine eighth notes instead of every six, we can find two more similar rolls.

$$\begin{matrix} M & T & I & M & I & M & I & M & T \\ I & & & T & & I & & T & \end{matrix}$$

$$\begin{matrix} M & T & M & I & M & I & M & I & T \\ I & & & T & & I & & T & \end{matrix}$$

Below are three more right-hand rolls that you should practice that will help make learning all of the above right-hand rolls easier.

$$\begin{matrix} M & T & M & T & M & T & M & T \\ I & & I & & I & & I & \end{matrix}$$

$$\begin{matrix} M & M & M & M & I \\ T & I & T & I & T \end{matrix}$$

$$\begin{matrix} I & M & I & M & I & M & I & M \\ T & & T & & T & & T & \end{matrix}$$

Finally, here are two more variations on this theme.

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} M & & & I & & M & \\ I & T & I & T & I & T & I \end{array}$$
$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} M & & & I & & I & \\ I & T & M & T & I & T & M \end{array}$$

It's good to practice these rolls with the downbeat falling in all different places.

[Here](#) is an instructional video that helps explain these rolls.